



Brainstorming for proposal

IB 431 – Behavioral Ecology
Fall 2025
September 18th 2025

Outline

- I. Brainstorm for proposals and meet with instructors to review feedback

Proposal brainstorming

- Summary of brainstorming due next **Thursday September 25th**
- Please review full description of assignment on Canvas
- Essentially a summary of brainstorming from class and responses to instructor feedback

Possible questions to discuss

- Describe your overall study idea to your classmates. Do any questions come up?
 - What is your study organism?
 - Observational or experimental study?
 - What behavior(s) will you measure and how will it be quantified? Are there any other behaviors you did not consider?
 - What is your experimental design – treatment groups vs. control groups?
 - What is your hypothesis? What do you predict will happen?
- If your predictions are not verified, how will you interpret the results?
 - In what way is your proposal relevant to broader questions (i.e., research on other species or topics)?
 - Is there any other background research that is needed?
 - Which of Tinbergen's 4 questions are you addressing in your proposal?